

If a factual error is clear, correct it promptly. Depending on severity, you might replace the audio file, add a spoken correction to a future episode, update show notes, correct a transcript or temporarily remove the episode while reviewing it.

A takedown demand, however, is not automatically proof that an episode is unlawful. Preserve evidence and obtain professional advice before reacting to threats involving major allegations, copyright disputes or substantial financial exposure.

Secure the material you collect

Raw recordings may contain the most dangerous material in the project: pre-interview chatter, personal numbers, unedited allegations, private stories that never reached publication and high-quality samples of a guest's voice.

Limit access. Use separate accounts for team members, strong unique passwords and multi-factor authentication where available. Avoid sharing an entire cloud drive when a freelancer needs only one episode folder. Remove access when a contributor leaves.

Keep a secure backup, but do not multiply sensitive files unnecessarily across devices and messaging apps. A leaked recording can harm a guest even when you never intended to publish it.

Disclose AI voices and manipulated audio up front

AI makes it increasingly easy to clean speech, translate a voice, generate narration or clone somebody's vocal characteristics. The ethical line is whether your audience could reasonably mistake synthetic material for something a real person actually said.

India amended the Information Technology Rules in February 2026 to address "synthetically generated information". The amended rules define covered synthetic audio, visual and audiovisual information while excluding routine good-faith operations such as noise reduction, transcription, compression, translation and technical correction where they do not materially alter or misrepresent the underlying content.



The amendments also impose due-diligence requirements on relevant intermediaries dealing with covered synthetic content. Among other measures, covered synthetic audio is contemplated with a prominent prefixed audio disclosure, while significant social-media intermediaries must require declarations concerning synthetic content and apply appropriate labels where it is identified as such.

For podcasters, adopt a simple policy even when a particular legal obligation falls on the platform rather than the creator: never use a cloned guest voice to fabricate words they did not say. Obtain permission before generating a recognisable synthetic voice. Clearly disclose AI-generated or materially altered speech, and preserve the original recording.

Routine removal of background hiss is editing. Making a guest appear to endorse a product they never mentioned is deception.



Build a pre-publication risk check

Before every episode goes live, spend ten minutes on a structured review:

- **Step 1:** Confirm guest permissions and releases are stored.
- **Step 2:** Verify that all music, images, clips and archival material are licensed or used on a defensible legal basis.
- **Step 3:** Flag allegations about identifiable people or organisations.
- **Step 4:** Recheck names, dates, statistics and quotations.
- **Step 5:** Remove unnecessary private information.
- **Step 6:** Confirm sponsor disclosures are clear in both the episode and relevant video treatment.
- **Step 7:** Review claims involving health, money, safety or other high-stakes decisions.
- **Step 8:** Label synthetic or materially manipulated content where required or ethically necessary.
- **Step 9:** Save the final master, transcript, release forms, licences and important source documents together.
- **Step 10:** If anything still makes the team uncomfortable, stop publication and get specialist advice. **d**